PAUSEAI UK

Donor Prospectus
November 2026

Contents

Executive Summary	3
Track Record	5
Theory of Change and Strategy	15
Past Expenses	21
Funding Targets	22

Executive Summary

Track Record

In the past year PauseAI UK has:

- **Delivered two conferences**, on behalf of PauseAI Global, bringing together volunteers from around the world, strengthening the global PauseAI community.
- **Written an open letter to Demis Hassabis signed by over 60 UK politicians**, establishing our political credibility and holding DeepMind to account.
- **Arranged a conference in the European Parliament** with speakers including **Brando Benifei**, the key architect of the EU AI Act, and **Stuart Russell**, one of the world's top AI scientists, discussing concrete steps to reduce AI extinction risk.
- **Co-organised the largest AI protest in the world**, with around 300 volunteers marching to the London headquarters of Google DeepMind, boosting our visibility and building towards our long-term vision of a mass movement.
- **Hired a brilliant Deputy Director**, Matilda da Rui, and gained many new talented and dedicated volunteers to help execute on more projects.
- **Supported several volunteers in founding local groups** across the UK, laying the foundations for the infrastructure that will enable us to scale.

Theory of change and strategy

We think that organising large numbers of citizens to boldly advocate for an AI pause will robustly help make the future go better. Public pressure for serious action on AI risks increases the likelihood of useful legislation and might be the only way that humanity avoids extinction.

We advocate for a global pause on AI development until there is broad consensus that superhuman general AI can be developed safely, with the benefits being widely shared. We are also in favour of other AI safety regulations, such as stronger liability for developers for AI-enabled harms.

We collaborate with other AI advocacy groups with different focus areas, but PauseAI UK positions itself as a movement focused on the risks of human-level and superhuman AI, rather than the current harms of AI. This allows us to direct our efforts towards the most severe issues, while also helping us scale rapidly as AI improves. PauseAI's strong SEO and name recognition are crucial assets because we automatically benefit when more people become concerned about AI risk. This turns AI companies and the progress of AI itself into our most effective marketing tool.

The UK is a valuable country in which to build a strong PauseAI movement because it has soft power with which it can help to convene discussions between the US and China, as with the first AI Safety Summit at Bletchley Park. London has the world's largest AI security institute and is a hub of AI research. There are more PauseAI members in London than any other city in the world. We have consistently held the largest AI protests since PauseAI began in May 2023, and we have seen a roughly exponential growth in the size of our demonstrations, with the number of attendees doubling approximately every 7 months.

We have recently launched our volunteering and project management platform, Catalyse PauseAI UK. In the next year we will strengthen our local volunteer groups and organise a protest with over 500 participants. We will nurture our political connections, advocate for a global pause and support legislation that moves us meaningfully closer to real safety guarantees.

Funding

The total cost for all of PauseAI UK's staff and activities is currently around £100k per year. To date, PauseAI Global has paid all of PauseAI UK's staff costs and other expenses. However, PauseAI is adopting a federated model in which national chapters operate as distinct legal entities and raise funding independently. Global is able to fund PauseAI UK until the end of Q2 2026.

We are seeking £425k in our main funding scenario which would allow us to support two additional full-time staff (for a total of four) for one year, alongside other part-time staff and consultants, while also providing an adequate budget for our operational costs and a major public event.

Track Record

June 2025 – PauseCon London

We delivered the first PauseAI conference, PauseCon, on behalf of PauseAI Global, bringing together around 60 volunteers from around the world for the first time and training them to be better organisers and communicators. We welcomed a range of excellent guest speakers from the AI safety community, including **Connor Leahy, Rob Miles, David Krueger and Kat Woods**.

PauseAI Germany, among others, came away from the event with renewed purpose and went on to organise a petition signed by 150 German professors. One volunteer, Didier Coeurnelle, was inspired to initiate and fund the next PauseCon in Brussels.



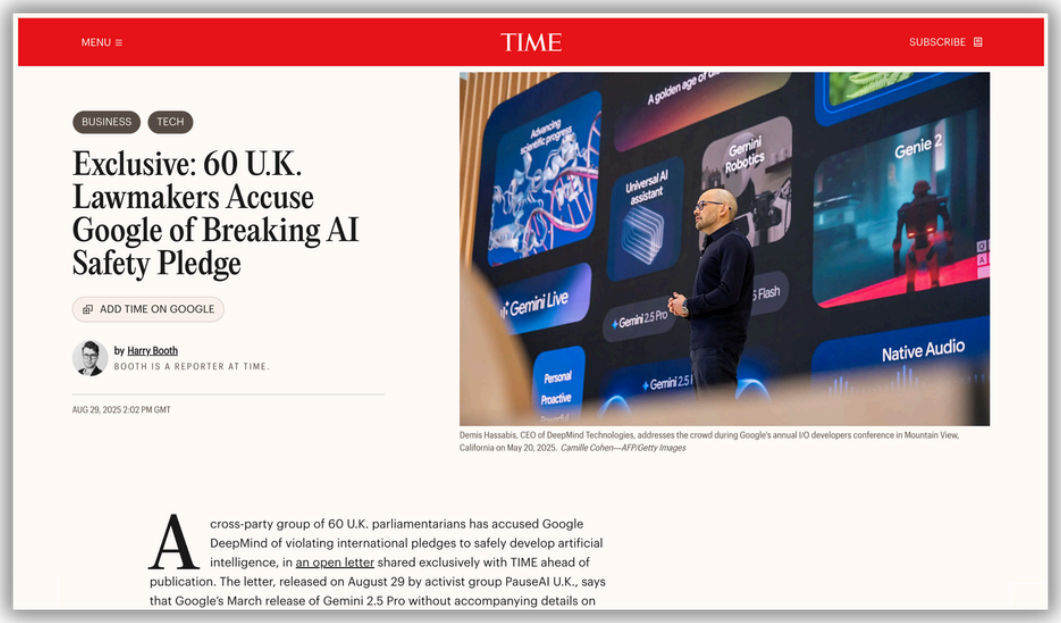




August 2025 – Open Letter to Demis Hassabis

In August we published an open letter **signed by over 60 UK politicians**, in response to Google DeepMind failing to uphold its AI safety commitments. Several of the MPs who signed later spoke in the Westminster Hall debate that we helped to organise in December (see below).

The article in TIME that broke the story established that Google DeepMind did not provide the UK AI Security Institute (AISI) with pre-deployment access to Gemini 2.5 Pro. Notably, Google did provide AISI with pre-deployment access to Gemini 3 Pro a couple of months after the letter was published.



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BUSINESS TECH

Exclusive: 60 U.K. Lawmakers Accuse Google of Breaking AI Safety Pledge

ADD TIME ON GOOGLE

by Harry Booth
BOOTH IS A REPORTER AT TIME.

AUG 29, 2025 2:02 PM GMT

Demis Hassabis, CEO of DeepMind Technologies, addresses the crowd during Google's annual I/O developers conference in Mountain View, California on May 20, 2025. *Camille Cohen—AFP/Getty Images*

A cross-party group of 60 U.K. parliamentarians has accused Google DeepMind of violating international pledges to safely develop artificial intelligence, in an open letter shared exclusively with TIME ahead of publication. The letter, released on August 29 by activist group PauseAI U.K., says that Google's March release of Gemini 2.5 Pro without accompanying details on

September 2025 – Book launch party

We held social events throughout the year, strengthening the sense of community that keeps people actively involved in PauseAI for months and years. One highlight was the book launch party for *If Anyone Builds It, Everyone Dies* in September.



October 2025 – Documentary Screening in Parliament

In October we held a screening in the UK Parliament of filmmaker Michaël Trazzi's documentary about SB-1047, the proposed California AI legislation. This helped to inform MPs and Peers about the kinds of AI legislation that could be in a UK AI bill, and the battle with Big Tech that they should expect to face.



December 2025 – Westminster Hall Debate

We proposed and helped to organise a Westminster Hall debate in Parliament on AI Safety. We wrote a memo which was sent to all MPs prior to the debate and drafted some of the speeches, putting us in a strong position to work with those MPs when proposing amendments to the Cyber Security and Resilience Bill.



February 2026 – PauseCon Brussels

We delivered the next PauseCon in Brussels on behalf of Global with another two days of training workshops for PauseAI organisers from around the world.

The final day included a public conference in the European Parliament, featuring several prominent speakers, including:

- **Professor Stuart Russell**, author of the authoritative textbook on AI.
- **Brando Benifei MEP**, primary architect of the EU AI Act.
- **Victor Negrescu MEP**, Vice-President of the European Parliament.
- **Risto Uuk**, Head of European Policy at the Future of Life Institute.



Brando Benifei discussed the strengths and limitations of the EU AI Act candidly and argued that the Act is not merely a product regulation, but that the code of practice can be extended to cover internal deployment within AI companies. We hope that PauseAI will be able to work with Mr Benifei to help see such changes implemented.

Many volunteer projects were initiated over the weekend and several attendees have since held meetings with their own MEPs to follow up on the issues discussed.







February 2026 – March for AI Safety

We co-organised a march past the offices of OpenAI and other Big Tech companies in King's Cross, London. **It was the largest ever protest focused exclusively on the risks of AI**, with around 300 people marching and media coverage in MIT Technology Review, The Independent, The Wall Street Journal and others.



The other organisers included *Pull the Plug*, a new group focused on the existing harms of AI. We consider the march a great success of coalition building between the historically opposed AI ethics and AI safety interests, with PauseAI and Pull the Plug represented in equal numbers.





June 2026 – Visit to Parliament

Volunteers from across the country contacted their Members of Parliament asking to meet at the House of Commons. We met with the following MPs (or their staff):

- **Anneliese Dodds**, MP for Oxford East (Labour)
- **Sarah Olney**, MP for Richmond Park (Liberal Democrats)
- **Jeremy Corbyn**, MP for Islington North (Your Party)
- **Monica Harding**, MP for Esher and Walton (Liberal Democrats)
- **Chris Vince**, MP for Harlow (Labour)
- **Siân Berry**, MP for Brighton Pavillion (Green)
- **Dame Meg Hillier**, MP for Hackney South and Shoreditch (Labour Co-op)



Our conversations were broadly successful, resulting in Chris Vince and Siân Berry writing letters to Kanishka Narayan MP (Minister for Artificial Intelligence), Anneliese Dodds and Siân Berry signing PauseAI UK's open letter, and other MPs requesting further meetings and briefings.







September 2026 – PauseCon London and Parliamentary Conference

We helped PauseAI Global to deliver the next PauseCon in London, bringing around 100 volunteers together from around the world and running workshops on social media management, communicating with news outlets, and strategy, among other topics. Many new connections were formed and by the end, people had been invited into high-impact roles that they would not have otherwise found.



To finish off, we held a Parliamentary conference with audience Q&A on AI policy, featuring:

- **Dame Chi Onwurah**, Chair of the Commons Science, Innovation and Technology Committee
- **Iqbal Mohamed MP**, led the December 2025 Westminster Hall debate on AI safety
- **Professor Stuart Russell**, world-renowned AI scientist
- **Lord Tim Clement-Jones**, Co-Chair of the All-Party Parliamentary Group on Artificial Intelligence
- **Lord Lionel Tarassenko**, Crossbench peer and President of Reuben College, Oxford
- **Brando Benifei MEP**, Co-rapporteur and lead architect of the EU AI Act





Topics covered ranged from the fact crimes are being committed, but governments are unable to hold anyone accountable because AI companies are not liable for the crimes of their AIs, to what needs to happen for an international superintelligence ban to come into play.

September 2026 – Emergency Protest outside Downing Street

In response to the media wave following Jacob Coxon leaving Anthropic over existential safety concerns, our volunteers organised an emergency protest in four days, with speakers ranging from AI safety researchers to our own volunteers. We had around 100 people show up at this short notice, with coverage from ITV News, Channel 4, the Guardian, and others.

Our main message to Andy Burnham was to convene an international pause treaty summit, putting the UK's G20 presidency to good use.





October 2026 – Oxford Panel Discussion

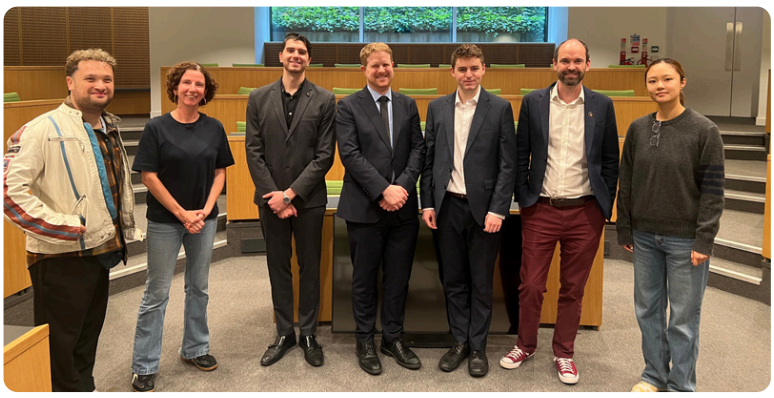
We held a panel discussion in Oxford, *Out of the Loop: Who's in Charge When AI Builds Itself?*, featuring:

- **Dame Anneliese Dodds**, MP for Oxford East and former shadow chancellor.
- **Toby Ord**, Senior Researcher at Oxford University's AI Governance Initiative.
- **Ben Harack**, Research Lead at the Oxford Hardware AI Governance Lab.
- **Catherine Ge-Wang**, MIRI Technical Governance fellow.









November 2026 – Edinburgh Panel Discussion

Who is responsible when AI goes wrong? How are Scottish politicians and technical and policy experts modelling the threats, uncertainties, opportunities and avenues that lie ahead?

We convened a panel of experts and politicians at the Playfair Library in Edinburgh to discuss the issues, propose solutions and answer questions from the public, with:

- **Luke McNally**, Senior Lecturer at the University of Edinburgh in complex systems and AI safety.
- **Susan Murray MP**, for Mid Dunbartonshire (Liberal Democrats).
- **David Kirkwood MSP**, for South Scotland (Reform), on the cross-party group on Science & Technology.
- **Ben Macpherson MSP**, for Edinburgh Northern and Leith (SNP), and former Minister for Innovation, Technology and Tertiary Education.
- **Carol Mochan MSP**, for South Scotland (Labour).
- **Councillor Lorenzo Martinico**, for Portobello/Craigmillar on the City of Edinburgh Council (Green).
- **Michael Rovatsos**, Professor of AI at the University of Edinburgh and former director of the Bayes Centre.
- **Jonathan Bostock**, AI alignment researcher at Arcadia Impact.









Theory of Change and Strategy

Creating the political momentum for a pause

Thousands of people in the UK believe that humanity might soon build dangerous superintelligent AI. And yet many of these people haven't even taken 10 seconds to email their MP about it.

Political intervention is currently the most plausible way that humanity can avoid catastrophe and there are many easy ways that anyone can help to improve the chance of useful AI legislation. If the thousands of people already concerned about superintelligence were well organised as a political force, they could wield substantial power to influence British AI policy.

Moreover, every month many more people notice how dangerous our current trajectory is. Awareness is accelerating rapidly as we get closer to catastrophe. PauseAI exists to provide useful structures and organise these people to have the most political impact as efficiently as possible.

Our mission

The proposal on PauseAI Global's website outlines our primary policy goal. In brief, we are aiming for a global pause on AI development regulated by an international AI Safety Agency (AISA) that is responsible for determining when more powerful AI systems can be safely developed. Any sufficiently large group of countries would be empowered to veto the deployment of a superhuman AI system to ensure that, if some countries feel that they will be excluded from the benefits of AI, they have a strong negotiating position with which to demand their fair share. Or, if a group of democratic countries believe that an authoritarian country will deploy AI to oppress its own people, they can push for a deployment that empowers all citizens in every country.

Before safe AI is technically feasible, it is in the interest of all major powers to enforce the treaty globally. Once AI alignment is solved, AISA will control any superhuman AI prior to deployment and be able to use it to enforce the agreement.

Such a treaty is possible to enforce due to the highly centralised AI chip supply chain. Writing highly detailed policy proposals is not our comparative advantage, so we generally defer to other organisations such as MIRI for draft treaty texts and the precise specifications of enforcement mechanisms.

Having said that, it is very valuable for PauseAI staff to have a strong working knowledge of AI legislation and governance proposals in order to be credible in our discussions with politicians. In one instance, we wrote a summary of existing AI safety legislation for British MPs.

As mentioned above, we are in favour of other AI safety regulations, such as stronger liability for developers for AI-enabled harms. We may sometimes explicitly push for such policies both because they increase AI safety directly and they can be instrumental in increasing PauseAI's influence or credibility. For example, our open letter signed by 60 UK lawmakers criticised Google DeepMind for violating the Frontier AI Safety Commitments and helped to establish our voice in British AI policy.

Positive outcomes for PauseAI UK

We cannot tell an exact story of what the path to a pause will look like, but we sketch below **two potential scenarios** where PauseAI UK has a positive impact. We are currently working towards realising both scenarios and in many ways they are complementary. At some point we may narrow our focus towards just one of these outcomes:

Scenario 1: PauseAI as a special interest group

PauseAI UK has 10,000 highly dedicated volunteers who act as a dominant lobbying force on AI policy matters. Whenever a politician touches AI, they receive a policy document with PauseAI's view on the matter and constant communications from PauseAI volunteers, in the vein of the US sugar lobby:

> *My phone did not stop ringing for the next five weeks. … I had no idea how many people in my district were connected to the sugar industry. People were calling all day, telling me they made pumps or plugs or boxes or some other such part used in sugar production and I was threatening their job. Mayors called to tell me about employers their towns depended on who would be hurt by a sugar downturn. It was the most organized effort I had ever seen.*

Each MP has 20 PauseAI volunteers in their constituency who will send emails to their office and request meetings in which all 20 constituents will show up to express their views. PauseAI UK uses its Catalyse platform to coordinate its network to push the government to introduce an AI bill and ensure that it has the backing of every MP.

In the wake of an AI warning shot, PauseAI UK's volunteers contact every major British newspaper to ensure that journalists mention the idea of a global pause treaty in every major article about the incident. Protests are held outside Downing Street and any event the prime minister attends every day until they initiate negotiations for a global pause treaty.

Scenario 2: PauseAI as a mass movement

PauseAI protests double in size every 7 months as AI capability itself improves exponentially. New PauseAI chapters are founded in every major UK city and many volunteers regularly put on talks in their local community to explain the risks of AI and recruit more volunteers for the movement.

At some point a significant, but not existential, AI catastrophe thrusts AI risks into the public consciousness and highlights the imminence of superhuman AI. Millions of British citizens become viscerally aware of the looming threat to their lives. PauseAI UK immediately announces a new protest and volunteers spread the sign-up page in their networks.

PauseAI UK organises a march in Westminster with 1 million attendees and dominates headlines in the British press. The prime minister is obliged to respond and commits to opening negotiations for a global pause treaty.

High-level strategy

Brand and messaging

PauseAI UK positions itself as a movement focused on the risks of human-level and superhuman AI, rather than the current harms of AI. This allows us to direct our efforts towards the most severe issues, while also letting us scale faster than movements focused on the existing harms of AI. PauseAI's strong SEO and name recognition are crucial assets because we automatically grow when more people become concerned about AI risk. This turns AI companies and the progress of AI itself into our most effective marketing tool.

A large fraction of our members have never been involved in grassroots advocacy before and we see this as a strength. It makes our protests more interesting to the media and makes the organisation more appealing to the silent majority who are not very politically active — unless, perhaps, they feel their lives are directly threatened.

We reflect our relatively moderate demographic in our messaging. We adopt a more measured tone than a typical advocacy group. Our imagery is upbeat and we emphasise that we are taking the moral high ground and we represent universal, common-sense human values as part of a historic cause. This also reinforces our absolute commitment to non-violence.





Within the range of concerns around AGI, we encompass a broad set of risks. Many people will be more motivated by the threat of job automation or autonomous killer robots than extinction, because these risks are already becoming tangible and are easier to conceptualise. They are very important concerns in their own right and they are a good stepping stone towards confronting the risk of extinction. We present different AI risks as part of a single spectrum which we move along as AI becomes more powerful.

We are cognisant that building an AI movement in a context where many people have an incomplete understanding of the most severe risks requires caution and continual shaping of our message. Having our primary policy demand built into our name is a good safeguard against harmful distortions of our goals. In many contexts there are large short-term incentives to water down our demands and message, but we think this would reduce our long-term impact by moving our focus away from the most severe risks, so we are glad to have a name that commits us to a strong stance. We remain strictly non-partisan by focusing exclusively on our single issue and using politically neutral language.

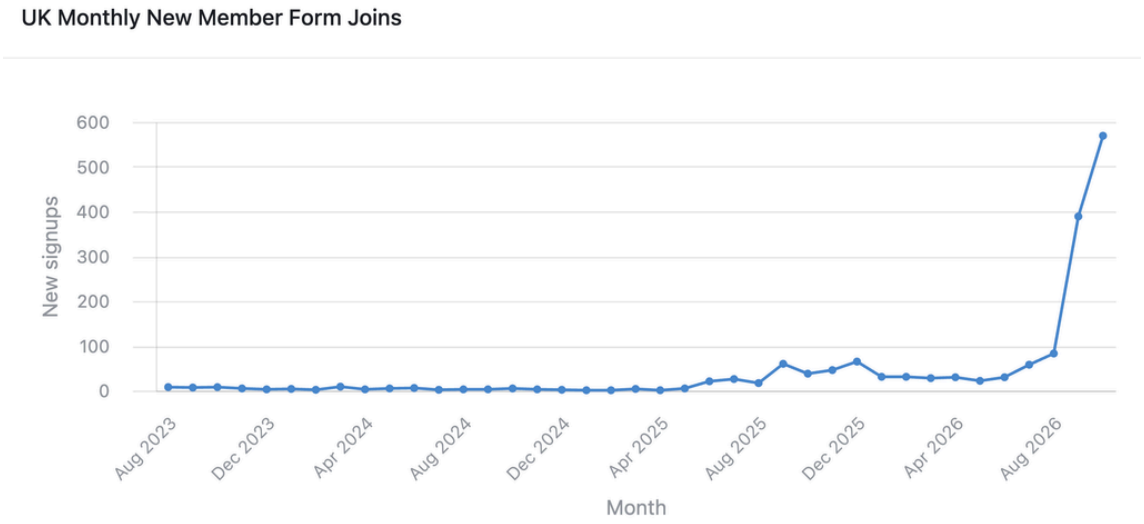
Why the UK?

PauseAI is starting chapters in every country and we think that having many different countries bought into the seriousness of AI risk will be critical to the success of a global treaty. But the UK is particularly valuable compared to other middle powers because it is a centre of AI research, including the headquarters of Google DeepMind and the second-largest offices of OpenAI and Anthropic. This soft power was demonstrated with the first AI Safety Summit at Bletchley Park.

Moreover, London is a hub of AI safety, with hundreds of AI safety researchers, the largest AI security institute and dozens of related organisations. The British public and political class are more aware of the risks of AI than those in comparable nations. Correspondingly, London has more PauseAI members and has consistently hosted larger protests than any other city in the world. These protests raise the bar for AI protests everywhere and can inspire others around the world to run bigger protests themselves.

Growth

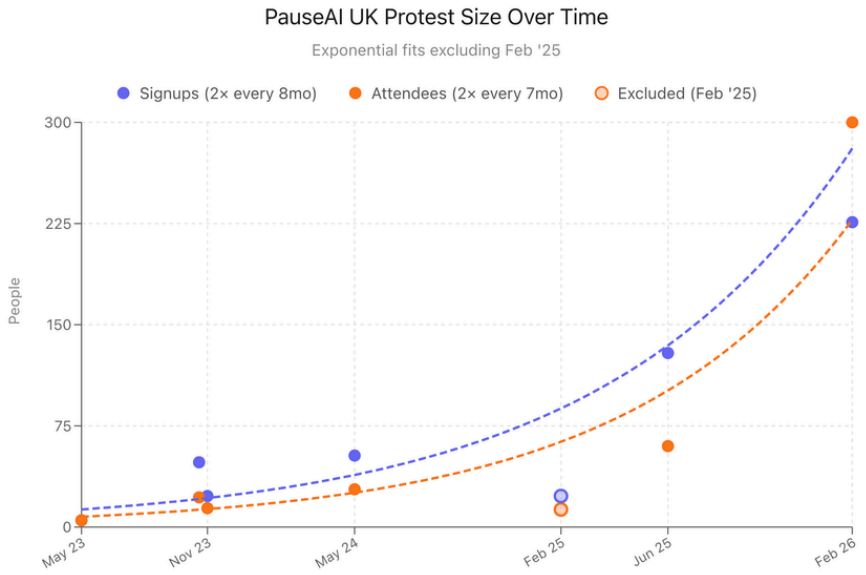
The fundamental bet of PauseAI UK is that there can be a very large and influential social movement dedicated to preventing the risks of advanced AI. Within PauseAI we already see evidence in our conversations with new members that a rapidly growing proportion of the population is truly grappling with the unprecedented danger that humanity is facing.



We model the population as a bell curve with respect to the level of evidence that each person requires to become concerned about superhuman AI. As AI improves, we expect the fraction of the curve that has crossed the threshold of concern to increase accordingly. If capabilities continue to progress exponentially, the number of people worried about the situation will also grow commensurately. However, that concern does not automatically translate into well-coordinated action. Our job is to provide the infrastructure and guidance to turn that energy into impact.

We do not think that convincing more of the public to be concerned about AI risks is our comparative advantage at the moment. This is both because other organisations are already dedicating significant resources to mass communications and because we think that AI progress itself will be the primary driver of our growth. We benefit from being the largest AI protest organisation and positioning ourselves as focused on the risks of future AI, which naturally funnels people concerned about those risks into our ranks.

Instead, we see our role as maximising the utility of whatever level of concern already exists in the population at any given time, so that we can get to a pause as early as possible. This means always organising the biggest protest possible, providing excellent infrastructure, onboarding and support for individual volunteers and local chapter leaders, and planning our campaigns carefully.



Since PauseAI UK began, we have seen a (very) roughly exponential growth in the size of our protests, with the number of attendees doubling approximately every 7 months. New members register every day and chapters are popping up across the UK. If we can continue and accelerate this trend, then we expect to make substantial progress towards our goals in a relatively short span of time.

Short-term plans

We will shortly be holding the world's largest march for AI safety. For an up-to-date list of upcoming events, see our events page: https://luma.com/pauseai.uk

Past Expenses

Calculating our historical costs is somewhat ambiguous as we have received significant assistance from PauseAI Global staff and until Q3 2026 we operated as a department of PauseAI Global. Below are conservative estimates of our total costs during the past year, including the time PauseAI Global staff spent helping with events that we delivered on behalf of Global.

2025 Expenses

PauseAI UK staff
€0
PauseAI Global staff [approx.]
½ FTE for 4 months at €63,000 p.a. (inc. tax) - €10,050
PauseCon London 2025
€18,830
Other events [estimate]
€1,000

Total for 2025 (rounded)
€29,900 EUR = $34,500 USD = £26,100 GBP

H1 2026 Expenses

PauseAI UK staff
Director - €10,000
Deputy Director - €20,000
PauseAI Global staff [approx.]
½ FTE for 2 months at €81,000 p.a. (inc. tax and fees) - €6,750
PauseCon Brussels 2026
€7,350
Feb 2026 London Protest and other events
€1,830

Total for H1 2026 (rounded)
€46,000 EUR = $51,500 USD = £38,400 GBP
Annualised rate (rounded)
€91,800 EUR = $102,800 USD = £76,700 GBP

Current Expenses

Our spending is currently changing rapidly, so it's difficult to give a stable estimate of our current spending.

In the past few months, we have recieved donations or donation commitments totally around £550,000. We are aiming to operate with approximately a 9 month runway, so we are aiming to spend around £60,000 per month over the next few months.

Our largest expense are our staff salaries. We are currently in process of hiring for several roles. These hires will soon be reflected on our website.